



ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

HARDWARE FREAKS

The latest Pentium processor, the best gaming console, the most expensive handheld are what they crave. Let's meet some people who only get out of their beds because of their lust for technology...

You must have come across them at one point in time or another—the shy, introverted type, with a few opinions on the latest movies or the hippest serials, and a taste in music that you find hard to digest. They'll rarely pose for a photograph or show up at social events. But mention technology in general or computers in particular, and their face lights up. Somehow they suddenly seem to come alive. You've just encountered a technology geek, or as they prefer to call themselves, 'A Digital Guru'.

They are out there

"She was a thing of beauty, a joy to work

with. Thin, sleek and very easy on the eyes... damn, I miss her!", says Kinnar Sanjanwala, an otherwise normal man, about his Apple notebook. "It's bad enough that my wife doesn't understand my passion, did she have to make me give her away?" Err... her away? "I called her [the notebook] Emily, from that Pink Floyd song. It isn't that strange you know. We give names to things we cherish, kids, pets... Heck! I know a guy who has named his shoes! At least with an inanimate object you don't have to worry about getting the name wrong."

Guys like Kinnar are not an uncommon breed; you will meet them in the unlikeliest of places, doing the most

normal of things (Kinnar is a chartered accountant). But once you get to know them, it won't be too long before their love for anything remotely related to technology emerges. And even if you can't identify yourself with their passion, it's infectious and chances are, they'll pass it on to you.

This 'passion', as Kinnar puts it, runs deep—it gives them a foundation to build their world upon and a feeling of power. Remember the time you had to call a friend because your PC was being its essential self—a pain? Chances are, your call for help sounded something like, "Hey Mangesh, could you help me out please, I think my computer hates

